ROJIKA SHARMA

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EDUCATION

May 2024 **Master of Arts in Urban, Regional, and Global Geography**
The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH

May 2022 **Bachelor of Arts in International Studies & Women and Gender Studies**
Denison University, Granville, OH
Minor: Studio Art

CERTIFICATIONS

Jul 2026 **Full-Stack JavaScript Certification** | *Color Coded Labs (CCL), Columbus, OH*
- Co-designed a community tool library offering affordable hardware rentals to neighbors after local floods and tornadoes (Cohort 9)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2022–2024 **Principal Researcher** | *The Ohio State University, Department of Geography*
- Secured IRB approval; recruited participants; conducted six ethnographic interviews
- Translated, coded, and analyzed qualitative data; produced final thesis report

2020–2022 **Student Research Assistant** | *Denison University, Dept. of Women and Gender Studies*
- Collected and annotated scholarly literature supporting research on Palestinian women in Germany

2020–2021 **Research Assistant** | *The Ohio State University, School of Social Work*
- Conducted 20+ interviews and provided translation for a study on mental health in the Bhutanese-Nepali community

2019 **Summer Research Scholar** | *Denison University, Dept. of Anthropology and Sociology*
- Conducted content analysis of South Asian online memes using semiotic theory; presented at annual poster session

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Aug 2026–Present **Adjunct Instructor, Geography 2750** | *Columbus State Community College, Columbus, OH*

Jul 2025 **Classroom Lead, Middle School ESL Program** | *BCCO Summer School, Columbus, OH*
- Assisted students in English language literacy workshops and provided one-on-one guidance
- Designed and implemented engaging classroom curriculum for middle school learners

Spring 2024 **Graduate Teaching Assistant, GEOG 3800 Environment and Society** | *The Ohio State University*
Supervisor: Dr. Becky Mansfield
- Conducted office hours to support student comprehension of course assignments and readings
- Graded exams and assignments, providing substantive feedback

Fall 2023 **Graduate Teaching Assistant, GEOG 3701 Making of the Modern World** | *The Ohio State University*
Supervisor: Dr. Theresa Hice-Fromille
- Held office hours and supported grading; maintained weekly attendance records

Spring 2023 **Graduate Teaching Assistant, GEOG 3701 Making of the Modern World** | *The Ohio State University*
Supervisor: Dr. Joel Wainwright
- Co-developed exam questions and graded 50+ bluebook exams per quarter
- Conducted office hours to support student learning

Fall 2022 **Graduate Teaching Assistant, GEOG 3701 Making of the Modern World** | *The Ohio State University*
Supervisor: Dr. Mathew Coleman
- Facilitated office hours and graded assignments for 60+ students

Fall 2021 **Teaching Assistant, WGST 310 Feminist Research Methods** | *Denison University*
Supervisor: Dr. Isis Nusair
- Edited course presentations and provided guidance to students on learning material

PROFESSIONAL & COMMUNITY EXPERIENCE

Oct 2026–Present **Platform Manager** | *WCEO, a women's economic nonprofit*
- Build the online directory on the organization's website, bringing a network of women business owners across Ohio into one place
- Lead weekly engagement with the online community through group chats
- Plan workshops for network participants
- Plan the user experience of the online community for participants from start to finish

Sep 2025–Present **Program Coordinator** | *Columbus Fashion Alliance (CFA)*
- Develop and implement adult program curricula alongside the Director of Programs
- Designed a four-week workshop enabling participants ages 18–24 to obtain retail certificates
- Coordinate workshops, training sessions, and outreach recruitment events

Jul 2024–Apr 2025 **Communication Support (Contract)** | *Bhutanese Community of Central Ohio (BCCO)*
- Produced annual reports for 2023 and 2024; managed website design using WordPress
- Planned and executed a 10th-anniversary fundraising campaign across multiple platforms

2022–2024 **Digital Archive Fellow** | *South Asian American Digital Archive (SAADA)*
- Conducted oral history project interviewing 7 Bhutanese refugees; published "Echoes of Home" digital archive
- Collaborated with artists and community leaders to ensure cultural authenticity in storytelling
- Managed project budgets with equity-centered practices in recruitment and data collection

2020–2021 **Social Media & Communications Intern** | *Ohio Progressive Asian Women's Leadership (OPAWL)*
- Led social media campaigns advocating for AAPI communities; increased member engagement by 25%
- Collaborated with activists and scholars to develop communication strategies and workshops

PUBLICATIONS

2024 **"Echoes of Home: Placemaking by and for Bhutanese Refugees in the Midwest"** | *South Asian American Digital Archive (SAADA), digital exhibit*
Interviews: Rojika Sharma; Artwork: Bikash Rai

2024 **"Digital Placemaking: Cultivating Belonging by and for Bhutanese Refugees in Central Ohio"** | *M.A. thesis, The Ohio State University*

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS & PANEL DISCUSSIONS

2023 **"Digital Placemaking of Refugees in Ohio"** | *ELDAAG, East Lake Division of the American Association of Geographers*

2023 **"Mapping Multiplicities As Scholar-Activists & Artists in Ohio" (panelist)** | *Inaugural bell hooks Symposium, Berea College*

2023 **"Mapping Multiplicities As Scholar-Activists & Artists in Ohio" (panelist)** | *Asian American Studies Conference, Michigan State University*

2022 **"Mapping South Asian Diaspora Aunties on Media"** | *South Asian Studies Initiative Brown Bag Series, OSU*

2022 **"Memefication of South Asian Aunties"** | *GLCA Women's, Gender, and Sexuality Studies Conference, Kalamazoo College*

2021 **"Mapping Multiplicities" (panelist)** | *Association for Ethnic Studies Conference, Bowling Green State University*

2019 **Harvard Kennedy Public Policy and Leadership Conference**

LEADERSHIP

2024–2025 **Board Member** | *Buckeye Environmental Network (BEN)*
- Oversaw grants and supported strategic plans for environmental advocacy in Ohio

2023–2024 **Social Chair** | *Graduate Student Government, The Ohio State University*
- Organized events and programming for geography graduate students

2019–2022 **Founder** | *Refugee Advocacy Collective (RAC), Denison University*
- Raised $600+ per semester; managed a 20-student team; organized workshops on immigration policy

HONORS & AWARDS

2022 **Archival Creators Fellowship** | *South Asian American Digital Archive (SAADA)*

2022 **Distinguished Student Leadership Award** | *Denison University*

2022 **Nan Nowik Award for Research** | *Dept. of WGST, Denison University*

2022 **Nan Nowik Award for Activism** | *Dept. of WGST, Denison University*

2019 **Summer Research Scholar ($4,000 stipend)** | *Denison University*

2018 **Columbus Alliance Scholarship (full four-year merit scholarship)** | *I Know I Can*

SKILLS

Research & Analysis: Qualitative Research, Ethnographic Interviewing, Content Analysis, IRB Protocol, Data Coding & Translation, Oral History Methods

Teaching & Curriculum: Curriculum Design, Classroom Facilitation, ESL Instruction, Student Mentoring, Assessment & Grading, Workshop Development

Communication & Digital: WordPress, Social Media Strategy (Instagram, Facebook, TikTok), Digital Archiving, Annual Report Design, Email Marketing, Public Speaking

Program Management: Project Coordination, Budget Management, Community Outreach, Event Planning, Stakeholder Engagement, Fundraising Campaigns

Languages: English (fluent), Nepali (fluent)

Technical: JavaScript, HTML, CSS